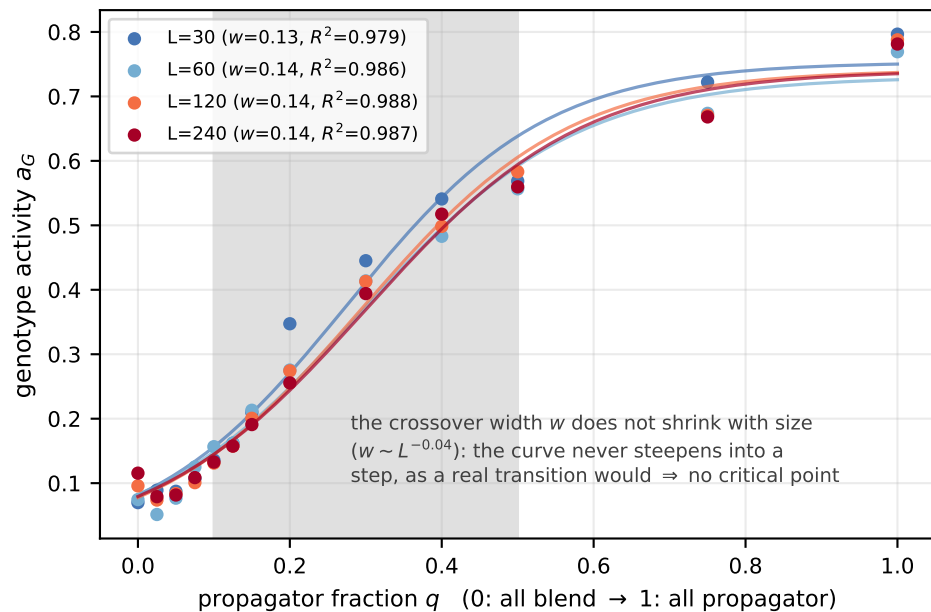
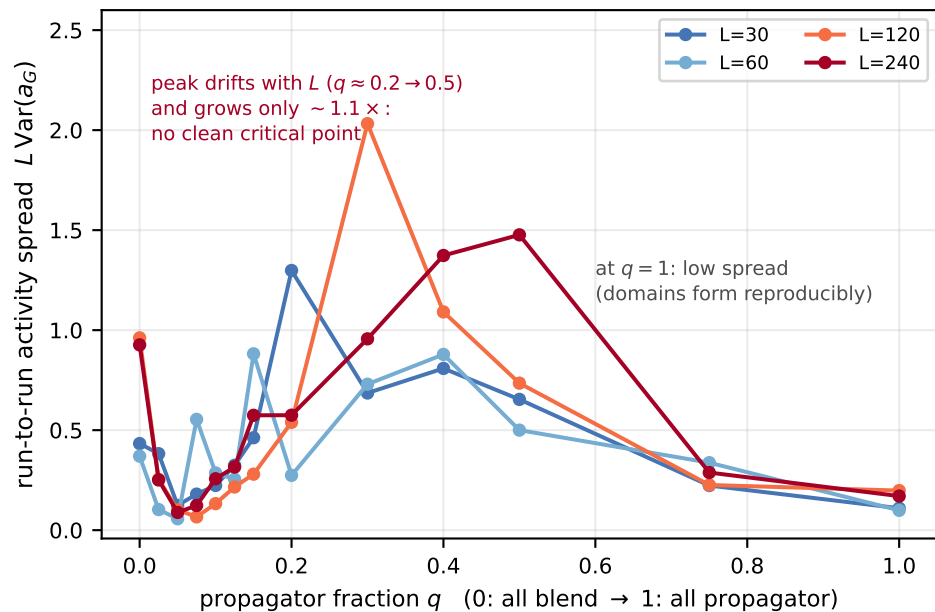


offset+1 feedforward scan across system size L (row width in cells, 30–240; 32 seeds): a smooth crossover with no critical point, and a susceptibility that peaks in the band but drifts and barely grows---metastability, not criticality (bottom: one realization across q , $L = 240$)

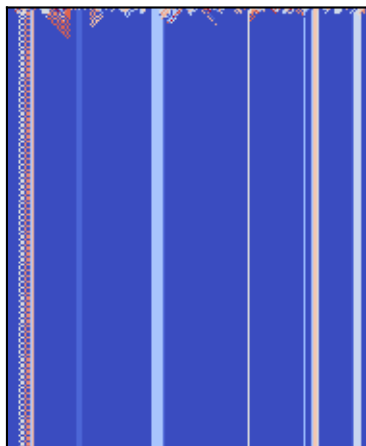
(a) activity a_G : a smooth crossover that never sharpens



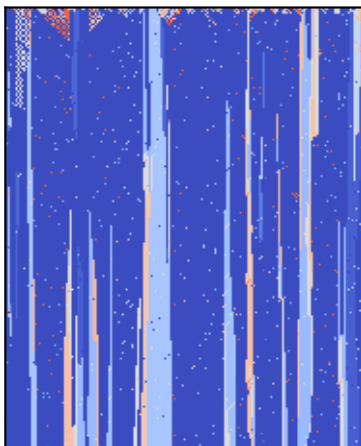
(b) susceptibility peaks in the band, but drifts and barely grows



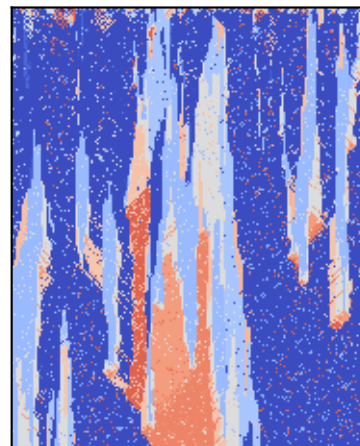
$q=0$: all blend (low activity)



$q=0.05$: sparse



$q=0.25$: coexisting domains



$q=1$: system-spanning domains

